

Highmark Commercial Medical Policy- WV/NY

Medical Policy: I-42-0323
Topic (or Title): Zoledronic Acid (Reclast, Zometa)
Section: Injections
Effective Date: ~~October 1, 2025~~ November 3, 2025
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Zoledronic acid (Reclast®, Zometa®) is a bisphosphonate that increases bone strength by inhibiting the rate of bone breakdown. Slowing the rate of bone break down allows the bone to recover and heal. The therapeutic effects include reducing bone pain, decreasing high levels of calcium in the blood and decreasing the risk of hip and spine fractures.

Policy Position

Zoledronic acid (Zometa) may be considered medically necessary for individuals 18 years of age and older for **ANY** of the following:

- Hypercalcemia of malignancy; **or**
- For the treatment of individuals with multiple myeloma or with documented bone metastases from solid tumors, in conjunction with standard antineoplastic therapy:
 - If using for individuals with prostate cancer, prostate cancer should have progressed after treatment with at least one hormonal therapy; **or**

Compendia Sources

Zoledronic acid (Zometa) may be considered medically necessary for treatment of any of the current category 1, 2A, or 2B NCCN recommendations; **or**

Other Medically Accepted Non-FDA Approved Recommendations, Class IIb or Higher Grade Recommendations

- As adjuvant therapy for early stage breast cancer; **or**
- For monoclonal gammopathy of uncertain significance with osteopenia or osteoporosis; **or**
- As prophylactic therapy for osteopenia, secondary to hormone therapy in individuals with breast cancer; **or**
- As prophylactic therapy for osteopenia, secondary to ovarian dysfunction induced by adjuvant chemotherapy in premenopausal women with early-stage breast cancer.

The use of zoledronic acid (Zometa) not meeting the criteria as indicated in this policy is considered not medically necessary.

Procedure Codes

J3489

Zoledronic acid (Reclast) may be considered medically necessary for **ANY** of the following:

- For treatment of osteoporosis in postmenopausal women and men who have a documented trial and failure, or contraindication to oral bisphosphonate therapy:
 - o Osteoporosis may be confirmed by the presence or history of osteoporotic fracture or by a finding of low bone mass (BMD more than 2.5 standard deviations below the normal adult reference population [i.e., T-score]). Osteoporosis may also be diagnosed in individuals with osteopenia (BMD T-score between 1 – 2.5 standard deviations below normal adult reference population) **AND** Fracture Risk Assessment Tool (FRAX) indicates ten (10) year probability for major osteoporotic fracture of greater than or equal to 20% or the ten (10) year probability of hip fracture is greater than or equal to 3%; **or**
- For the prevention of osteoporosis in postmenopausal women who have a documented trial and failure, or contraindication to oral bisphosphonate therapy; **or**
- For the treatment and prevention of glucocorticoid-induced osteoporosis in men and women who are either initiating or continuing systemic glucocorticoids in a daily dosage equivalent to 7.5 mg or greater of prednisone and are expected to remain on glucocorticoids for at least 12 months:
 - o Individual has documented trial and failure, or contraindication to oral bisphosphonate therapy; **or**
- For the treatment of Paget's disease in both men and women for **ANY** of the following:
 - o With elevations in serum alkaline phosphatase of two times or higher than the upper limit of the age-specific normal reference range; **or**
 - o For those who are symptomatic; **or**
 - o For those at risk for complications from their disease.

The use of zoledronic acid (Reclast) not meeting the criteria as indicated in this policy is considered not medically necessary.

Note: If the individual can tolerate oral bisphosphonates, then the injectable form is considered not medically necessary, and therefore, not covered.

Procedure Codes

J3489

Note: Failure of oral bisphosphonate therapy will be defined as a six (6) to twelve (12) month trial with **ANY** of the following:

- A new fracture despite bisphosphonate therapy of six months or more; **or**
- A T-score less than or equal to -2.5 despite bisphosphonate therapy of 12 months or more.

NOTE: In addition to the above criteria, product specific dosage and/or frequency limits may apply in accordance with the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA)-approved product prescribing information, national compendia, Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) and other peer reviewed resources or evidence-based guidelines. Highmark may deny, in full or in part, reimbursement for utilization that does not fall within the applicable dosage and/or frequency limits.

Related Policies

Refer to Medical Policy X-24 for guidelines on Bone Mineral Density Studies.

Diagnosis Codes

Covered Diagnosis Codes for J3489

C33	C34.00	C34.01	C34.02	C34.10	C34.11	C34.12
C34.2	C34.30	C34.31	C34.32	C34.80	C34.81	C34.82
C34.90	C34.91	C34.92	C50.011	C50.012	C50.019	C50.021
C50.022	C50.029	C50.111	C50.112	C50.119	C50.121	C50.122
C50.129	C50.211	C50.212	C50.219	C50.221	C50.222	C50.229
C50.311	C50.312	C50.319	C50.321	C50.322	C50.329	C50.411
C50.412	C50.419	C50.421	C50.422	C50.429	C50.511	C50.512
C50.519	C50.521	C50.522	C50.529	C50.611	C50.612	C50.619
C50.621	C50.622	C50.629	C50.811	C50.812	C50.819	C50.821
C50.822	C50.829	C50.911	C50.912	C50.919	C50.921	C50.922
C50.929	C50.A0	C50.A1	C50.A2	C61	C64.1	C64.2
C64.9	C65.1	C65.2	C65.9	C66.1	C66.2	C66.9
C68.0	C68.1	C68.8	C68.9	<u>C69.29</u>	C73	C79.51
C90.00	C90.01	C90.02	C90.10	C90.11	C90.12	C90.20
C90.21	C90.22	C90.30	C90.31	C90.32	C94.30	C94.31
C94.32	C96.0	C96.20	C96.21	C96.22	C96.5	C96.6
<u>C96.9</u>	<u>C96.Z</u>	D05.10	D05.11	D05.12	D05.80	D05.81
D05.82	D47.02	E83.52	M80.00XA	M80.00XD	M80.00XG	M80.00XK
M80.00XP	M80.00XS	M80.011A	M80.011D	M80.011G	M80.011K	M80.011P
M80.011S	M80.012A	M80.012D	M80.012G	M80.012K	M80.012P	M80.012S
M80.019A	M80.019D	M80.019G	M80.019K	M80.019P	M80.019S	M80.021A
M80.021D	M80.021G	M80.021K	M80.021P	M80.021S	M80.022A	M80.022D
M80.022G	M80.022K	M80.022P	M80.022S	M80.029A	M80.029D	M80.029G
M80.029K	M80.029P	M80.029S	M80.031A	M80.031D	M80.031G	M80.031K
M80.031P	M80.031S	M80.032A	M80.032D	M80.032G	M80.032K	M80.032P
M80.032S	M80.039A	M80.039D	M80.039G	M80.039K	M80.039P	M80.039S
M80.041A	M80.041D	M80.041G	M80.041K	M80.041P	M80.041S	M80.042A
M80.042D	M80.042G	M80.042K	M80.042P	M80.042S	M80.049A	M80.049D
M80.049G	M80.049K	M80.049P	M80.049S	M80.051A	M80.051D	M80.051G
M80.051K	M80.051P	M80.051S	M80.052A	M80.052D	M80.052G	M80.052K
M80.052P	M80.052S	M80.059A	M80.059D	M80.059G	M80.059K	M80.059P
M80.059S	M80.061A	M80.061D	M80.061G	M80.061K	M80.061P	M80.061S
M80.062A	M80.062D	M80.062G	M80.062K	M80.062P	M80.062S	M80.069A
M80.069D	M80.069G	M80.069K	M80.069P	M80.069S	M80.071A	M80.071D
M80.071G	M80.071K	M80.071P	M80.071S	M80.072A	M80.072D	M80.072G

M80.072K	M80.072P	M80.072S	M80.079A	M80.079D	M80.079G	M80.079K
M80.079P	M80.079S	M80.08XA	M80.08XD	M80.08XG	M80.08XK	M80.08XP
M80.08XS	M80.0AXA	M80.0AXD	M80.0AXG	M80.0AXK	M80.0AXP	M80.0AXS
M80.80XA	M80.80XD	M80.80XG	M80.80XK	M80.80XP	M80.80XS	M80.811A
M80.811D	M80.811G	M80.811K	M80.811P	M80.811S	M80.812A	M80.812D
M80.812G	M80.812K	M80.812P	M80.812S	M80.819A	M80.819D	M80.819G
M80.819K	M80.819P	M80.819S	M80.821A	M80.821D	M80.821G	M80.821K
M80.821P	M80.821S	M80.822A	M80.822D	M80.822G	M80.822K	M80.822P
M80.822S	M80.829A	M80.829D	M80.829G	M80.829K	M80.829P	M80.829S
M80.831A	M80.831D	M80.831G	M80.831K	M80.831P	M80.831S	M80.832A
M80.832D	M80.832G	M80.832K	M80.832P	M80.832S	M80.839A	M80.839D
M80.839G	M80.839K	M80.839P	M80.839S	M80.841A	M80.841D	M80.841G
M80.841K	M80.841P	M80.841S	M80.842A	M80.842D	M80.842G	M80.842K
M80.842P	M80.842S	M80.849A	M80.849D	M80.849G	M80.849K	M80.849P
M80.849S	M80.851A	M80.851D	M80.851G	M80.851K	M80.851P	M80.851S
M80.852A	M80.852D	M80.852G	M80.852K	M80.852P	M80.852S	M80.859A
M80.859D	M80.859G	M80.859K	M80.859P	M80.859S	M80.861A	M80.861D
M80.861G	M80.861K	M80.861P	M80.861S	M80.862A	M80.862D	M80.862G
M80.862K	M80.862P	M80.862S	M80.869A	M80.869D	M80.869G	M80.869K
M80.869P	M80.869S	M80.871A	M80.871D	M80.871G	M80.871K	M80.871P
M80.871S	M80.872A	M80.872D	M80.872G	M80.872K	M80.872P	M80.872S
M80.879A	M80.879D	M80.879G	M80.879K	M80.879P	M80.879S	M80.88XA
M80.88XD	M80.88XG	M80.88XK	M80.88XP	M80.88XS	M80.8AXA	M80.8AXD
M80.8AXG	M80.8AXK	M80.8AXP	M80.8AXS	M81.0	M81.6	M81.8
M84.451A	M84.452A	M84.459A	M84.551A	M84.552A	M84.553A	M84.559A
M84.651A	M84.652A	M84.653A	M84.659A	M85.9	M88.0	M88.1
M88.811	M88.812	M88.819	M88.821	M88.822	M88.829	M88.831
M88.832	M88.839	M88.841	M88.842	M88.849	M88.851	M88.852
M88.859	M88.861	M88.862	M88.869	M88.871	M88.872	M88.879
M88.88	M88.89	M88.9	M89.9	M94.9	T38.0X5A	T38.0X5D
T38.0X5S	T38.5X5A	T38.5X5D	T38.5X5S	T38.6X5A	T38.6X5D	T38.6X5S
T38.7X5A	T38.7X5D	T38.7X5S	Z78.0	Z79.51	Z79.52	

Removing:

C40.00

C40.01

C40.02

C40.10

C40.11

C40.12

C40.20

C40.21

C40.22

C40.30

C40.31

C40.32

C40.80

C40.81

C40.82

C40.90

C40.91

C40.92

C41.0

C41.1

C41.2

C41.3

C41.4

C41.9

C66.1

C66.2

C66.9

C68.0

C68.1

C68.8

C68.9

C76.0

C78.00

C78.01

C78.02

C79.00

C79.01

C79.02

C79.52

C79.81

C79.82

Place of Service: Outpatient

Experimental/Investigational (E/I) services are not covered regardless of place of service.

The administration of Zoledronic Acid (Reclast, Zometa) is typically an outpatient procedure which is only eligible for coverage as an inpatient procedure in special circumstances, including, but not limited to, the presence of a co-morbid condition that would require monitoring in a more controlled environment such as the inpatient setting.

The policy position applies to all commercial lines of business

Links

- [Link to Provider Resource Center for the Medical Policy Update](#)
06/2018, Coverage Guidelines Revised for Zoledronic Acid (Reclast, Zometa)
- [Link to References](#)

This policy is designed to address medical guidelines that are appropriate for the majority of individuals with a particular disease, illness, or condition. Each person's unique clinical or other circumstances may warrant individual consideration, based on review of applicable medical records, as well as other regulatory, contractual and/or legal requirements.

Medical policies do not constitute medical advice, nor are they intended to govern the practice of medicine. They are intended to reflect Highmark's reimbursement and coverage guidelines. Coverage for services may vary for individual members, based on the terms of the benefit contract, and subject to the applicable laws of your state.

Highmark retains the right to review and update its medical policy guidelines at its sole discretion. These guidelines are the proprietary information of Highmark. Any sale, copying or dissemination of the medical policies is prohibited; however, limited copying of medical policies is permitted for individual use.

Discrimination is Against the Law

The Claims Administrator/Insurer complies with applicable Federal civil rights laws and does not discriminate on the basis of race, color, national origin, age, disability, or sex. The Claims Administrator/Insurer does not exclude people or treat them differently because of race, color, national origin, age, disability, or sex. The Claims Administrator/ Insurer:

- *Provides free aids and services to people with disabilities to communicate effectively with us, such as:*

- o Qualified sign language interpreters
 - o Written information in other formats (large print, audio, accessible electronic formats, other formats)
- Provides free language services to people whose primary language is not English, such as:
 - o Qualified interpreters
 - o Information written in other languages

If you need these services, contact the Civil Rights Coordinator.

If you believe that the Claims Administrator/Insurer has failed to provide these services or discriminated in another way on the basis of race, color, national origin, age, disability, or sex, you can file a grievance with: Civil Rights Coordinator, P.O. Box 22492, Pittsburgh, PA 15222, Phone: 1-866-286-8295, TTY: 711, Fax: 412-544-2475, email: CivilRightsCoordinator@highmarkhealth.org. You can file a grievance in person or by mail, fax, or email. If you need help filing a grievance, the Civil Rights Coordinator is available to help you.

You can also file a civil rights complaint with the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, Office for Civil Rights electronically through the Office for Civil Rights Complaint Portal, available at <https://ocrportal.hhs.gov/ocr/portal/lobby.jsf>, or by mail or phone at:

*U.S. Department of Health and Human Services
200 Independence Avenue, SW
Room 509F, HHH Building
Washington, D.C. 20201
1-800-368-1019, 800-537-7697 (TDD)*

Complaint forms are available at <http://www.hhs.gov/ocr/office/file/index.html>.

Insurance or benefit/claims administration may be provided by Highmark, Highmark Choice Company, Highmark Coverage Advantage, Highmark Health Insurance Company, First Priority Life Insurance Company, First Priority Health, Highmark Benefits Group, Highmark Select Resources, Highmark Senior Solutions Company or Highmark Senior Health Company, all of which are independent licensees of the Blue Cross and Blue Shield Association, an association of independent Blue Cross and Blue Shield plans.

ATTENTION: If you speak English, language assistance services, free of charge, are available to you. Call the number on the back of your ID card (TTY: 711).

ATENCIÓN: Si usted habla español, servicios de asistencia lingüística, de forma gratuita, están disponibles para usted. Llame al número en la parte posterior de su tarjeta de identificación (TTY: 711).

请注意：如果您说中文，可向您提供免费语言协助服务。

请拨打您的身份证背面的号码（TTY: 711）。

CHÚ Ý: Nếu quý vị nói tiếng Việt, chúng tôi cung cấp dịch vụ hỗ trợ ngôn ngữ miễn phí cho quý vị. Xin gọi số điện thoại ở mặt sau thẻ ID của quý vị (TTY: 711).

알림: 한국어를 사용하시는 분들을 위해 무료 통역이 제공됩니다. ID 카드 뒷면에 있는 번호로 전화하십시오 (TTY: 711).

ATENSYON: Kung nagsasalita ka ng Tagalog, may makukuha kang mga libreng serbisyong tulong sa wika. Tawagan ang numero sa likod ng iyong ID card (TTY: 711).

ВНИМАНИЕ: Если вы говорите по-русски, вы можете воспользоваться бесплатными услугами языковой поддержки. Позвоните по номеру, указанному на обороте вашей идентификационной карты (номер для текст-телефонных устройств (TTY): 711).

تنبيه: إذا كنت تتحدث اللغة العربية، فهناك خدمات المعاونة في اللغة المجانية متاحة لك. اتصل بالرقم الموجود خلف بطاقة هويتك (جهاز الاتصال لذوي صعوبات السمع والنطق: 711).

ATTENTION: Si c'est créole que vous connaissez, il y a un certain service de langues qui est gratis et disponible pour vous-même. Composez le numéro qui est au dos de votre carte d'identité. (TTY: 711).

ATTENTION: Si vous parlez français, les services d'assistance linguistique, gratuitement, sont à votre disposition. Appelez le numéro au dos de votre carte d'identité (TTY: 711).

UWAGA: Dla osób mówiących po polsku dostępna jest bezpłatna pomoc językowa. Zadzwoń pod numer podany na odwrocie karty ubezpieczenia zdrowotnego (TTY: 711).

ATENÇÃO: Se a sua língua é o português, temos atendimento gratuito para você no seu idioma. Ligue para o número no verso da sua identidade (TTY: 711).

ATTENZIONE: se parla italiano, per lei sono disponibili servizi di assistenza linguistica a titolo gratuito. Contatti il numero riportato sul retro della sua carta d'identità (TTY: 711).

ACHTUNG: Wenn Sie Deutsch sprechen, steht Ihnen unsere fremdsprachliche Unterstützung kostenlos zur Verfügung. Rufen Sie dazu die auf der Rückseite Ihres Versicherungsausweises (TTY: 711) aufgeführte Nummer an.

注：日本語が母国語の方は言語アシスタンス・サービスを無料でご利用いただけます。ID カードの裏に明記されている番号に電話をおかけください (TTY: 711)。

توجه : اگر شما به زبان فارسی صحبت می کنید، خدمات کمک زبان، به صورت رایگان، در دسترس شماست. با شماره واقع در پشت کارت شناسایی خود (TTY: 711) تماس بگیرید.